INTRODUCTION · DETAILED

Kamloops Life Guide

A free, six-language guide to settling in Kamloops: fourteen step-by-step task cards and a map of 287 verified places, made for newcomers doing a dozen unfamiliar things at once — and for everyone who helps them.

Website: `https://kamloops-lifemap.neilxiang.workers.dev` · Version 2026.09.13f · Places last checked 2026-09-11 · Prepared September 2026

Scan to open the guide on a phone, or type `https://kamloops-lifemap.neilxiang.workers.dev` into any browser — no app, no sign-in, nothing asked of you first.

1. The problem it answers

Someone who has just arrived in Kamloops has to do a dozen things in an order nobody tells them, at offices they cannot picture, with documents they may not have — and often in a second language. Official websites are accurate but written for people who already know the vocabulary; friends and forums are friendly but out of date. Front-line staff at the City, the library, the settlement agency and the health authority answer the same questions every day, one person at a time.

Kamloops Life Guide puts those answers on one page that fits in a pocket. It is deliberately narrow: not everything about Kamloops, only the things that stop a household from functioning when they are missing. The aim throughout is to make an already stressful season a little less so — accurate rather than clever, and patient about the fact that everything here is unfamiliar at first.

2. What is inside

14	287	14	6
task cards in three groups	places · 51 categories · 7 areas	BC Transit routes · 475 named stops	languages, complete on every screen

The guide: fourteen task cards

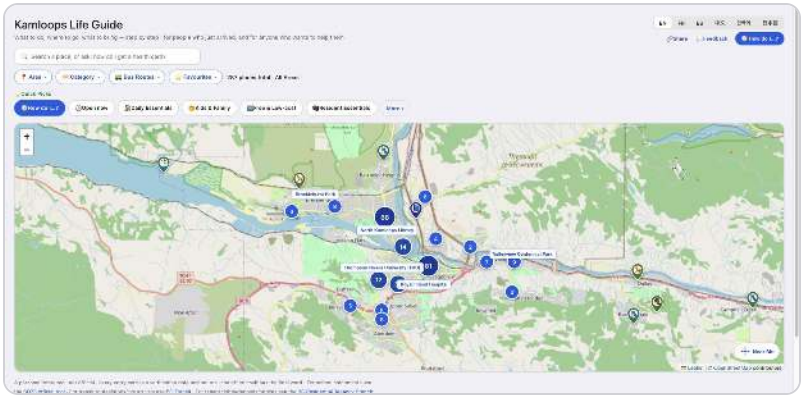
Each card starts from the resident’s own question rather than the program’s name, and answers it the same way every time: *why it matters · the steps · what to bring · where to go (address, phone, hours, map pin) ·*

cost · how long it takes · the deadline · what to say at the counter · what to do if you get stuck · the official source it was checked against, with the date. A card can be ticked as done, shared as a link, printed on one page, or (where there is a deadline) added to a phone calendar.

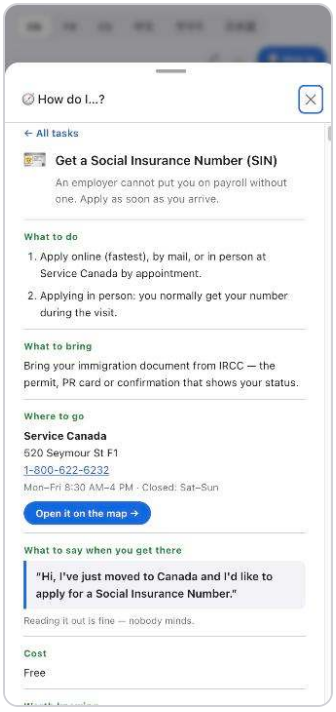
First weeks	
Sit down with a settlement worker	“I do not know what I do not know — who can walk me through it?”
Get a Social Insurance Number (SIN)	“I need to be able to work and be paid”
Apply for MSP and get a BC Services Card	“I need health coverage — and I might get sick before it starts”
Switch to a BC driver’s licence	“I want to drive here — and I heard there is a deadline”
Open a bank account	“I need a bank account, but I have no job here yet”
Register a child for school (SD73)	“I need to get my child into school”
Ongoing	
File a tax return — especially on a low income	“I earned little or nothing — do I still have to file taxes?”
Meet people in this city	“I do not know anyone here”
Get help caring for an older relative	“My parent is getting older and needs help at home”
When something goes wrong	
Get care without a family doctor	“I am sick and I do not have a family doctor”
Get your deposit back	“My landlord is keeping my deposit, or charging fees I doubt”
Get help when money runs out	“I cannot cover food or rent this month”
File a human rights complaint	“I was treated unfairly because of who I am”
Get free legal help	“I have a legal problem and cannot afford a lawyer”

The map: 287 verified places

Every place carries its address, phone, website, opening hours (with an “open now” state computed for Kamloops time), a short note in six languages, the date it was last checked and the kind of source it was checked against. Places are grouped into 51 categories (government and immigration, medical, dental, pharmacies, schools, daycare, libraries, groceries, Asian markets, food bank, legal aid, thrift stores, transit, banks, post, housing, community centres, religious sites, parks, pools, trails, Indigenous services, crisis support…) across seven areas of the city, and tagged with ten themes such as *Free & Low-cost*, *Kids & Family*, *Indoor / Winter* and *Multicultural*. Fourteen BC Transit routes are drawn on the map with every stop named. The six emergency and support lines (911, 811, 211, 310-6789, 1-800-784-2433, 9-8-8) are one tap away from every screen.



The guide entrance and the map, on a desktop browser.



A task card on a phone.

3. How it is made and kept honest

- **Sources.** Task cards are written from the official program pages (Service Canada, Service BC / ICBC, Health Insurance BC, SD73, CRA, the Residential Tenancy Branch, the BC Human Rights Tribunal, Legal Aid BC…) and re-read against them; the check date (2026-09-08) is printed at the foot of every card. Place facts come from the organisations' own websites and Google Places; each record shows its own date.
- **Verification rules.** A place whose hours cannot be established is shown as "hours unknown", never as "open" or "closed". Twenty-eight places whose exact building could not be confirmed from two independent sources are flagged "approximate location" and navigation uses the street address, not the pin. Records that could not be confirmed at all are held back rather than shown.
- **Corrections.** Anyone — a resident, an organisation that is listed, a City department — can email a correction. Errors are fixed, and an organisation that does not wish to be listed is removed, within five working days.
- **Freshness.** The whole set was last checked on 2026-09-11; the version number (2026.09.13f) is printed in the page footer so a printed card can be matched to what was live that day.

4. Privacy, security and legal position

No personal data

No account, no sign-up, no cookies used to identify anyone, no location stored. “Near me” asks the phone once and keeps nothing. Favourites and ticked cards stay in the reader’s own browser.

Usage counts only

Anonymous counts of which cards and filters are used, carried by a random identifier that is rotated every 90 days and cannot be linked to a person. No advertising, no third-party trackers; the visit counter is Cloudflare’s cookie-free one.

Not an official source

The page says so on every screen: a personal reference, not published by any government or organisation, not legal, medical, immigration or tax advice. In an emergency it says: call 911.

Open licence

Text and structure are released under Creative Commons BY-NC 4.0: the City, libraries, schools and non-profits may print, copy and adapt it freely with attribution. Facts (addresses, hours) are not claimed as anyone’s property.

Hosting: Cloudflare (Canada/global edge). The page sends a strict Content-Security-Policy, cannot be embedded inside another website, and works offline once loaded (it can be installed to a phone’s home screen). It is governed by the laws of British Columbia.

5. Ways it can be used — all free

Setting	How it helps
Front counters, 311, reception	Hand over a link, a QR flyer (Letter/A4, black-and-white friendly, already designed) or a printed card instead of re-explaining the steps. The card is one page and in the resident’s language.
Welcome packages, libraries, community centres	Insert the flyer; the QR code opens the guide in the phone’s language. No app store, no download.
Settlement, health and school partners	Staff share a single card by link (for example `?task=msp`) or a filtered map (“pharmacies open now on the North Shore”). Every share carries the language.
A scoped edition	The page can be built as a scoped edition — only the categories or area an organisation serves, with its own name and contact line on the page — without changing the underlying data.
Feedback loop	If a partner organisation spots an error or a change (a moved office, new hours), one email fixes it for every language at once.

6. What it is not, and what comes next

It is not a directory of every business, not a replacement for 211 or the City’s own pages, and not a channel for reporting problems to the City.

> **To go further.** A 20-minute walkthrough for staff, a batch of printed flyers, or a scoped edition for one organisation can be arranged at no cost. Write to neilxiang@hotmail.com — happy to help it reach more people.

Kamloops Life Guide is a personal, non-commercial project by Neil Xiang. It is not published by, affiliated with, or endorsed by the City of Kamloops, the Province of British Columbia, the Government of Canada, or any organisation listed in it. Corrections and questions: neilxiang@hotmail.com.